Thomas Karas

Manager, Data Platform & Operations

My Contact

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About Me

Data platform and operations leader with experience modernizing enterprise analytics, integrating acquisition data, and translating complex business needs into governed, scalable data products. Combines hands-on data architecture expertise with cross-functional leadership to accelerate reporting, AI-enabled analysis, and operational decision-making.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Business Administration

Information Analytics and Finance. Minor in Political Science.

University of Colorado

Technical Stack

- Snowfllake
- Dbt
- SQL | SOQL
- Salesforce
- Python
- Tableau| Hex
- Jira, Confluence and Gitlab
- Cortex Code, Claude Code, Codex

Expertise

- Cross-Organizational Stakeholder Management
- Scrum Agile Methodology and Product Ownership
- Data Architecture, Analysis & Visualization
- Ai Data Anaylsis and Reporting
- Collaborative Data-Driven Execution

References

- **Leidy Perez | VP, Strategic Software**
- **Hannah Wanderer | SVP, Product Management**
- **Kylie Powell | VP, Business Systems**
- **Lindee Weickmann | Manager, Product Inventory**

Professional Experience

Manager, Data Platform & Operations | UPSTACK

June 2025– Present

- Co-Led the end-to-end redesign and reconstruction of enterprise data warehouse layers using dbt, designing staging, base, and data mart models from the ground up to eliminate data gaps and optimize reporting efficiency.
- Successfully migrated all analytical workflows and AI data consumption from a Postgres OLTP system to Snowflake's OLAP platform, enhancing data access performance and scalability.
- Implemented a comprehensive data catalog for the new data layers to centralize metadata management, improve data discoverability, and ensure governance across the organization.
- Established a robust semantic layer to ensure data consistency and accelerate AI reporting capabilities and enterprise analytics.
- Deployed Hex as a self-serve platform for AI-powered report generation and conversational analytics, empowering business users for autonomous data exploration and insights.
- Directed the centralized reporting analyst team, standardizing workflows and governance practices to ensure a single source of truth and maintain high data accuracy across all enterprise analytics.
- Integrated autonomous AI agents to execute complex analytical tasks, reducing turnaround times from weeks to under an hour and significantly accelerating operational throughput.

M&A Integration Analyst | UPSTACK

April 2024 – May 2025

- Directed the successful migration and transformation of data from three M&A acquisitions, seamlessly integrating disparate data into our core source systems.

Sr. Project Manager | Lightpath

June 2023 – Present

- Coordinated multi-team hackathons for Finance, Sales,and Service Delivery to overhaul their Board facing Tableau Metric Dashboards along with their day-to-day reporting.
- Strategized the 2024 IT Project Roadmap, mapping our resource allocation in collaboration with Business Unit Leaders and Technical Leads.
- Acted as the Product Owner for our Data Warehouse and Reporting Team, managing the backlog and roadmap whileimproving efficiencies with stakeholder communications and issue prioritization.

Technical Product Manager - Scrum Product Owner | Zayo Group

October 2021 – June 2023

Responsibilities

- Driving execution of the software product lifecycle for product inventory development, including requirements gathering, data analysis, collaboration with scrum team and roll out strategy
- Designed and provided technical requirements and solutions for Salesforce object automation for Fiber Inventory (Buildings, Locations, Services, Fiber Spans, etc)
- System redesign and requirements lead for Salesforce One overhaul in alignment with new access strategy for buildings and locations
- Team Lead for Data Validation team responsible for data clean up and mass updates

Key Projects

- Led Mid Market Enterprise Building Automation including implementation of network architecture across inventory systems and customer portal. This enabled quote-to-cash of 11 markets with over 500k buildings
- Led Building Management application strategy, including back end and front end, for data automation and governance resulting in a single interface for all record creation, substituting 4 entry points to the inventory system and enforcing data policy

Business Analyst | Zayo Group

September 2020 – September 2021

- Analyzed key aspects of the business to evaluate factors driving results and summarized them into presentations
- Managed SQL Tables in the data warehouse that feed metric objects in Salesforce and Analytics Dashboards
- Led a team of college software engineering students for a spatial network development project
- Acted as subject matter expert for complex data cleanup exercises
- Performed GIS analysis to conduct mass building infrastructure changes based on Fiber Builds

Data Analyst Intern | Zayo Group

June 2020 – August 2020

- Performed customer intelligence gathering for Top Revenue Generating Accounts
- Created and implemented tools to assist with data cleanup related to account, contact, building, and location record management
- Validated and loaded customer intelligence data to various databases including Salesforce
- Developed and nurtured strong inter-departmental communications to ensure timely resolution of customer and sales issues and concerns

Policy Intern | Designing for Defense (Department of Defense)

December 2018 – June 2019

- Developing a policy proposal to develop new programs, change institutional protocols and adjust cultural holes.
- Applied Lean Startup Methodology to a problem sponsored by U.S Army Special Operations Command regarding the talent management of high-quality mid-career Special Forces Officers
- Conducted interviews and briefings with senior Army Officers including Generals.